THE HANDBOOK CHECK

Where do I start?

The Handbook is not a course you must read from page 1. It is a map of everything a pianist reads, hears and plays. This check finds the chapters you already know and the ones to study, so you start exactly where you are.

How it works

1

Choose a part

New to music? Start with Part I. Otherwise begin with the part you need, or do all eight, one part at a time (about 5 minutes each).

2

Answer three questions

for each chapter: circle A, B or C. No book, no piano, no guessing: if you don't know, leave it.

3

Mark and map it

Check with the answers on the last pages, write your score, then colour the chapter on your map (page 16).

What your score means

3 RIGHT

Skip it

You know this chapter. Glance at its secret and move on.

2 RIGHT

Skim it

Read the chapter's opening picture and Examples; check the one you missed.

0 OR 1 RIGHT

Study it

Start here: read the whole chapter and do its workbook pages.

An example

Ex Sample chapter: the musical alphabet Handbook p.22

1 After G, the musical alphabet goes on with...
(A) H (B) A (C) C

2 How many different letter names are there?
(A) 7 (B) 8 (C) 12

3 Going down from C, the next letter is...
(A) D (B) A (C) B

Right: 3 / 3 3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.22

For teachers

Give one part as a ten-minute warm-up at the first lesson. The map shows at a glance which chapters to set, and repeating the check each term shows progress chapter by chapter.

Online: the same check marks itself and draws your map: Library › Handbook check.

Part I · Pitch

P1 The keyboard

Handbook p.22

1 The white key just left of a group of two black keys is...
(A) C (B) D (C) F

2 The white key just left of a group of three black keys is...
(A) F (B) C (C) G

3 Moving to the right on the keyboard, the notes get...
(A) lower (B) louder (C) higher

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.22

P2 The staff and the clefs

Handbook p.27

1 The treble clef curls round the line for...
(A) G (B) C (C) F

2 The two dots of the bass clef hug the line for...
(A) G (B) F (C) A

3 How many lines does a staff have?
(A) 4 (B) 5 (C) 6

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.27

P3 The staff and the keyboard

Handbook p.29

1 Moving up one line or space on the staff moves you...
(A) one black key up (B) one white key up (C) two white keys up

2 From a line to the next line up is...
(A) an octave (B) a skip (a 3rd) (C) a step (a 2nd)

3 Bass F (between the bass clef's dots) and treble G (where the treble clef curls) are...
(A) next-door keys (B) the same distance either side of Middle C (C) the same key

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.29

P4 Reading the notes

Handbook p.32

1 In the treble clef, the bottom line is...
(A) F (B) G (C) E

2 In the treble clef, the spaces from the bottom spell...
(A) E G B D (B) F A C E (C) A C E G

3 Middle C is written...
(A) on the top line of the treble staff (B) on a ledger line between the two staves
(C) in the middle of the bass staff

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.32

P5 Ledger lines

Handbook p.36

1 A note on the first ledger line below the treble staff is...
(A) Middle C (B) A (C) E

2 Ledger lines are read by...
(A) stepping out from the nearest staff line (B) counting from the top of the staff
(C) counting from the outermost ledger line

3 8va over a passage means play it...
(A) an octave higher (B) an octave lower (C) twice as loud

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.36

P6 Sharps, flats and naturals

Handbook p.39

1 A sharp moves a note...
(A) one key to the right (B) one key to the left (C) one octave up

2 A sharp written in front of a note lasts...
(A) for the whole piece (B) until the end of the bar (C) for that one note only

3 F♯ and G♭ are...
(A) two different keys (B) both white keys (C) one key with two names

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.39

P7 Counting intervals

Handbook p.42

1 C up to E is a...
(A) 3rd (B) 4th (C) 2nd

2 C up to G is a...
(A) 4th (B) 6th (C) 5th

3 D up to the next D is a...
(A) 7th (B) octave (8th) (C) 9th

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.42

P8 Major, minor and perfect

Handbook p.45

1 A major 3rd has how many keys in between?
(A) 3 (B) 4 (C) 2

2 A perfect 5th has how many keys in between?
(A) 7 (B) 6 (C) 5

3 C up to E♭ is a...
(A) major 3rd (B) minor 3rd (C) perfect 4th

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.45

Part II · Time

T1 Pulse, tempo and the bar

Handbook p.50

1 The steady beat underneath the music is the…
(A) rhythm (B) pulse (C) melody

2 In each bar, the strongest beat is usually…
(A) beat 2 (B) beat 1 (C) the last beat

3 The speed of the beat is the…
(A) tempo (B) key (C) pitch

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.50

T2 Notes and rests

Handbook p.53

1 In 4/4, a minim lasts…
(A) 2 beats (B) 1 beat (C) 4 beats

2 How many quavers make one crotchet?
(A) 2 (B) 3 (C) 4

3 A semibreve rest can mean…
(A) a whole bar of silence (B) one beat of silence (C) half a beat of silence

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.53

T3 How long is a note?

Handbook p.56

1 A dotted minim lasts…
(A) 3 beats (B) 2 beats (C) 4 beats

2 A dotted crotchet lasts…
(A) 1 beat (B) 2 beats (C) 1½ beats

3 Two notes of the same pitch joined by a tie: you…
(A) play once and hold for both (B) play both (C) play the second louder

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.56

T4 Time signatures

Handbook p.59

1 In 3/4, the top number means…
(A) three quavers in each beat (B) three bars on each line (C) three beats in each bar

2 In 2/4, the bottom number 4 means each beat is a…
(A) crotchet (B) minim (C) quaver

3 Which fills one bar of 3/4?
(A) two minims (B) a semibreve (C) a minim and a crotchet

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.59

T5 Compound and irregular time

Handbook p.62

1 In compound time each beat divides into…
(A) two (B) four (C) three

2 At most speeds, a bar of 6/8 has…
(A) 6 beats (B) 2 beats (C) 3 beats

3 Which time signature is compound?
(A) 3/4 (B) 2/2 (C) 9/8

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.62

T6 Rhythm: groups and upbeats

Handbook p.65

1 A triplet is…
(A) three tied notes (B) three beats in a bar (C) three notes in the time of two

2 An upbeat (anacrusis) is…
(A) the last note of a piece (B) notes before the first full bar (C) a loud first beat

3 In 4/4, which pair of beats may NOT share one beam?
(A) beats 3 and 4 (B) beats 1 and 2 (C) beats 2 and 3

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.65

T7 Rhythm: off the beat

Handbook p.68

1 Syncopation means…
(A) every note is short (B) the music gets faster (C) the stress falls off the beat

2 Swing quavers are played…
(A) short–long (B) long–short (C) exactly even

3 A hemiola makes two bars of 3/4 feel like…
(A) three big beats of two (three minims) (B) one bar of 6/8 (C) four beats of one

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.68

T8 Repeats and road signs

Handbook p.71

1 |: A B :| C — you play…
(A) A B C (B) A B A B C (C) A B C A B C

2 D.C. al Fine means…
(A) go back to the sign (B) play faster to the end (C) go back to the start and stop at Fine

3 With 1st and 2nd time bars, the second time through you…
(A) play both (B) play only the 1st-time bar (C) skip the 1st-time bar

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.71

Part III · Expression

E1 Loud and soft

Handbook p.76

1 Which is the softest?
(A) pp (B) p (C) mp

2 mf means...
(A) very loud (B) half soft (C) half loud

3 A hairpin that opens means...
(A) getting louder (B) getting softer (C) getting faster

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.76

E2 Touch: smooth, short, strong

Handbook p.79

1 A dot above or below a note means...
(A) stronger (accent) (B) hold it longer (C) short (staccato)

2 A curve over different notes means...
(A) play them twice (B) join them smoothly (C) hold them twice as long

3 A line (tenuto) over a note means...
(A) play it very loud (B) play it short (C) hold it its full length

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.79

E3 Speed words

Handbook p.82

1 Andante means...
(A) at a walking pace (B) very slow (C) very fast

2 rit. means...
(A) back to the first speed (B) gradually slower (C) gradually faster

3 ♩ = 60 means...
(A) 60 notes in a bar (B) 60 bars in the piece (C) 60 beats in a minute

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.82

E4 The pedals

Handbook p.85

1 Ped. means...
(A) press the right pedal down (B) press the left pedal down (C) play louder

2 On a new chord, you change the pedal...
(A) just after you play it (B) only at the end (C) just before you play it

3 u.c. (una corda) means...
(A) lift every pedal (B) use the right pedal (C) use the left, soft pedal

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.85

E5 Ornaments

Handbook p.88

1 A trill on E goes back and forth between E and...
(A) G (B) F (C) D

2 A tiny note with a slash (acciaccatura) is...
(A) played after the main note (B) held for half the main note (C) crushed in, as fast as possible

3 A turn on D is played...
(A) C D E (B) D E D (C) E D C D

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.88

Part IV · Scales and keys

S1 Major scales

Handbook p.93

1 Every major scale follows the pattern...
(A) T T T S T T S (B) T T S T T T S (C) T S T T S T T

2 In T T S T T T S, a T (tone) has...
(A) no key between (B) one key between (C) two keys between

3 In every major scale, the semitones fall between notes...
(A) 2–3 and 5–6 (B) 3–4 and 7–8 (C) 4–5 and 7–8

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.93

S2 Minor scales

Handbook p.96

1 C natural minor is C major with which notes one key lower?
(A) only 3 (B) 3, 6 and 7 (C) 2, 4 and 6

2 The harmonic minor is the natural minor with...
(A) the 6th and 7th lowered one key (B) the 7th raised one key (C) the 3rd raised one key

3 The melodic minor coming down is the same as...
(A) the major scale (B) the harmonic minor (C) the natural minor

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.96

S3 Keys and key signatures

Handbook p.99

1 A key signature applies to...
(A) every note of that name, all through (B) the first bar only (C) the next note only

2 One sharp, F♯, is G major or...
(A) D minor (B) E minor (C) A minor

3 The order of sharps begins...
(A) B E A (B) F C G (C) C G D

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.99

S4 Finding the key

Handbook p.102

1 With sharps, the major key is...
(A) the first sharp (B) the last sharp itself (C) the very next key up from the last sharp

2 With flats, the major key is...
(A) the first flat (B) the second-last flat (C) the last flat

3 One sharp, D♯s all through, ending on E: the key is...
(A) E minor (B) G major (C) D major

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.102

S5 The circle of fifths

Handbook p.105

1 Going right (clockwise) round the circle adds...
(A) one flat (B) two sharps (C) one sharp

2 The major key with one flat is...
(A) B♭ major (B) G major (C) F major

3 Next to C major on the circle are...
(A) D major and B♭ major (B) A major and E major (C) G major and F major

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.105

Part V · Chords

H1 Chords and triads

Handbook p.110

1 A triad is built by...
(A) play one, skip one, play one (B) three black keys (C) three keys in a row

2 The notes of the C major triad are...
(A) C F A (B) C D E (C) C E G

3 The note a chord is named after is its...
(A) 3rd (B) root (C) 5th

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.110

H2 Four kinds of triad

Handbook p.113

1 In a major triad, the keys between (root to 3rd, 3rd to 5th) are...
(A) 3 + 2 (B) 2 + 2 (C) 2 + 3

2 A triad with 2 + 2 keys between is...
(A) minor (B) augmented (C) diminished

3 C E♭ G is...
(A) C minor (B) C diminished (C) C major

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.113

H3 Chords in a key

Handbook p.116

1 In C major, chord V is...
(A) G (B) F (C) A minor

2 Capital Roman numerals (I, IV, V) are...
(A) major chords (B) seventh chords (C) minor chords

3 In C major, chord ii is...
(A) E minor (B) D major (C) D minor

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.116

H4 Inversions

Handbook p.119

1 E G C is the C chord in...
(A) 2nd inversion (B) root position (C) 1st inversion

2 In 2nd inversion, the bottom note is the...
(A) 5th (B) 3rd (C) root

3 An inversion keeps the chord's name but changes...
(A) the bottom note (B) the root (C) the kind of chord

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.119

H5 Seventh chords

Handbook p.122

1 G7 is...
(A) G B D F♯ (B) G B D F (C) G B♭ D F

2 A seventh chord adds to the triad...
(A) a note below (B) a 2nd above the root (C) one more 3rd on top

3 Cmaj7 is...
(A) C E♭ G B♭ (B) C E G B♭ (C) C E G B

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.122

H6 Colour chords

Handbook p.125

1 Csus4 is...
(A) C E G A (B) C D G (C) C F G

2 A power chord, C5, is...
(A) C and G only (B) C F G (C) C E G

3 C6 is...
(A) C E G B (B) C E G A (C) C E G D

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.125

H7 The tower: 9, 11, 13

Handbook p.128

1 The 9th has the same letter name as the…
(A) 6th (B) 4th (C) 2nd

2 The 13th has the same letter name as the…
(A) 6th (B) 5th (C) 3rd

3 C9 is…
(A) C E G D (B) C E G B♭ D (C) C E G A

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.128

H8 Slash chords

Handbook p.131

1 C/E means…
(A) only C and E (B) a C chord, then an E chord (C) a C chord with E as the lowest note

2 In G/B the bass note is…
(A) D (B) B (C) G

3 In F/G the bass note G is…
(A) the 3rd of the F chord (B) the root of the F chord (C) not a note of the F chord

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.131

Part VI · Harmony in music

M1 Chords from outside the key

Handbook p.136

1 In C major, D F♯ A has the guest note…
(A) D (B) F♯ (C) A

2 A sharp guest note usually moves…
(A) nowhere (B) up one key (C) down one key

3 In C major, the A♭ in F minor (F A♭ C) usually moves…
(A) up two keys, to B♭ (B) down one key, to G (C) up one key, to A

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.136

M2 Cadences

Handbook p.139

1 V to I is a…
(A) perfect cadence (B) plagal cadence (C) interrupted cadence

2 IV to I (the “Amen”) is a…
(A) plagal cadence (B) perfect cadence (C) imperfect cadence

3 A phrase that ends on V has an…
(A) perfect cadence (B) imperfect cadence (C) plagal cadence

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.139

M3 Chords under a melody

Handbook p.142

1 To choose a chord for a bar, look at...
(A) its main notes (strong beats, long notes) (B) its lowest note (C) its last note only

2 In C major, a bar whose main notes are D and B takes chord...
(A) I (B) V (C) IV

3 An Alberti bass on C plays...
(A) C G E G (B) C C G G (C) C E G E

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.142

M4 Progressions everywhere

Handbook p.144

1 The pop four in C (I V vi IV) is...
(A) C F G C (B) C Am F G (C) C G Am F

2 The twelve-bar blues starts with...
(A) I IV V I (B) four bars of I (C) four bars of V

3 ii V I in C is...
(A) Dm G C (B) D G C (C) Em F C

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.144

Part VII · Shape and style

F1 Motifs and phrases

Handbook p.148

1 A motif is...
(A) a short idea that comes back (B) a speed word (C) a whole piece

2 Most phrases are...
(A) 16 bars long (B) 4 bars long (C) 1 bar long

3 In C major, a phrase that ends on D sounds like a...
(A) full stop (B) question (C) answer

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.148

F2 Repetition and sequence

Handbook p.150

1 C D E, then D E F is...
(A) a sequence (B) a repetition (C) a contrast

2 The left hand copying the right hand a bar later is...
(A) a sequence (B) a contrast (C) imitation

3 C D E, then C D E again is...
(A) imitation (B) a sequence (C) repetition

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.150

F3 Texture

Handbook p.152

1 A tune with block chords underneath is...
(A) homophonic (B) polyphonic (C) monophonic

2 Two independent tunes at once is...
(A) monophonic (B) homophonic (C) polyphonic

3 One line alone, with no chords, is...
(A) monophonic (B) homophonic (C) polyphonic

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.152

F4 Changing key

Handbook p.154

1 In C major, an F♯ that keeps coming back usually means the music has moved to...
(A) F major (B) D minor (C) G major

2 A modulation is...
(A) a change of speed (B) a change of time signature (C) a change of key

3 One passing F♯ in a bar of C major is...
(A) a decoration, not a new key (B) a mistake (C) always a new key

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.154

F5 Form

Handbook p.156

1 A B A is...
(A) rondo form (B) ternary form (C) binary form

2 A B A C A is...
(A) ternary form (B) theme and variations (C) rondo form

3 A A^1 A^2 A^3 is...
(A) strophic form (B) rondo form (C) theme and variations

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.156

F6 Styles through time

Handbook p.159

1 Bach belongs to the...
(A) Baroque period (B) Romantic period (C) Classical period

2 An Alberti bass and tidy 4-bar phrases suggest the...
(A) Classical period (B) Baroque period (C) Modern period

3 Rubato and rich pedalling suggest the...
(A) Romantic period (B) Classical period (C) Baroque period

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.159

Part VIII · Playing and listening

L1 Fingering

Handbook p.163

1 In both hands, the thumb is finger…
(A) 5 (B) 0 (C) 1

2 Right hand, C major going up: after finger 3 on E, the F is played by…
(A) finger 4 (B) the thumb, passing under (C) finger 5

3 Right-hand thumb on C, five-finger position: G is finger…
(A) 4 (B) 3 (C) 5

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.163

L2 Practising well

Handbook p.165

1 Which bar should you practise first?
(A) the hardest one (B) the easiest one (C) the first one

2 When do you set the metronome one notch faster?
(A) after one try (B) after three correct times in a row (C) never

3 Practising fast with mistakes…
(A) does no harm (B) teaches your fingers the mistakes (C) is the quickest way to learn

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.165

L3 Sight-reading

Handbook p.167

1 Before you sight-read, check first…
(A) the title only (B) the key and time signatures (C) the last bar

2 A wrong note while sight-reading: you…
(A) keep the beat going (B) go back one bar (C) stop and start again

3 Choose a speed that…
(A) is as fast as possible (B) you can keep all the way (C) is exactly the marked speed

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.167

L4 Listening

Handbook p.169

1 In Twinkle, the 2nd to the 3rd note (“twin-kle TWIN”) is a…
(A) perfect 5th (B) octave (C) major 3rd

2 A minor chord usually sounds…
(A) darker than a major chord (B) brighter than a major chord (C) exactly like a major chord

3 A phrase that stops on chord V sounds…
(A) finished (B) not finished (C) louder

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.169

L5 Performing

Handbook p.171

1 Before the first note, you...

(A) look at the audience (B) start at once (C) breathe and feel a bar of the beat

2 After a slip in a performance, you...

(A) stop and say sorry (B) go back and fix it (C) keep going and rejoin on the next beat

3 Nerves before you play...

(A) are normal (B) mean you are not ready (C) should stop you playing

Right: ☐ / 3

3 skip · 2 skim · 0–1 study p.171

THE HANDBOOK CHECK

Answers

One line per chapter: question number and letter. Count your right answers and write the score in the chapter's box.

P1	1A 2A 3C	**P2**	1A 2B 3B	**P3**	1B 2B 3B	**P4**	1C 2B 3B
P5	1A 2A 3A	**P6**	1A 2B 3C	**P7**	1A 2C 3B	**P8**	1A 2B 3B
T1	1B 2B 3A	**T2**	1A 2A 3A	**T3**	1A 2C 3A	**T4**	1C 2A 3C
T5	1C 2B 3C	**T6**	1C 2B 3C	**T7**	1C 2B 3A	**T8**	1B 2C 3C
E1	1A 2C 3A	**E2**	1C 2B 3C	**E3**	1A 2B 3C	**E4**	1A 2A 3C
E5	1B 2C 3C	**S1**	1B 2B 3B	**S2**	1B 2B 3C	**S3**	1A 2B 3B
S4	1C 2B 3A	**S5**	1C 2C 3C	**H1**	1A 2C 3B	**H2**	1A 2C 3A
H3	1A 2A 3C	**H4**	1C 2A 3A	**H5**	1B 2C 3C	**H6**	1C 2A 3B
H7	1C 2A 3B	**H8**	1C 2B 3C	**M1**	1B 2B 3B	**M2**	1A 2A 3B
M3	1A 2B 3A	**M4**	1C 2B 3A	**F1**	1A 2B 3B	**F2**	1A 2C 3C
F3	1A 2C 3A	**F4**	1C 2C 3A	**F5**	1B 2C 3C	**F6**	1A 2A 3A
L1	1C 2B 3C	**L2**	1A 2B 3B	**L3**	1B 2A 3B	**L4**	1A 2A 3B
L5	1C 2C 3A						

THE HANDBOOK CHECK

My map

Colour one circle for each chapter you check. Green chapters you can skip; yellow ones skim; red ones are where you start. Check again in a few months and watch the map turn green.

◯ skip it (3) ◯ skim it (2) ◯ study it (0–1)

Part I · Pitch

P1	The keyboard	p.22	◯ ◯ ◯
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P3	The staff and the keyboard	p.29	◯ ◯ ◯
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